Michael Wacha

RHP · KC · 2026 · 3,031 pitches

Family 5: High slot, true to slot

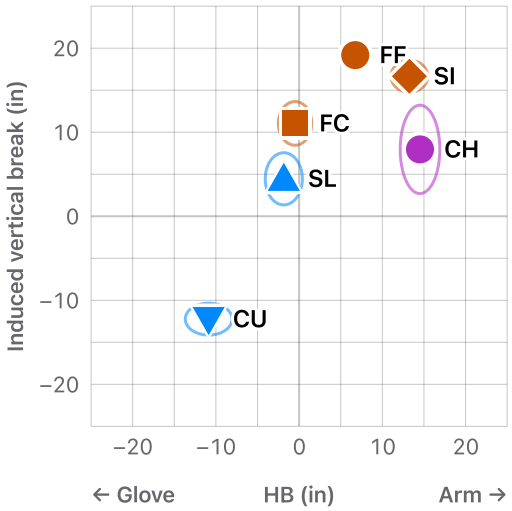
5 | 55° Slot | 100% Efficiency | 0° Tilt | 23 BU Spin

High slot, true to slot Reference: Four-seam

12:45

High slot (54°) with a four-seam that sits true to the slot (–1°), spun very cleanly (99% efficient), with low spin for its velocity (23 BU).

Arsenal Movement



Averages with one-standard-deviation ovals. Drawn from behind the pitcher: arm side is to the right.

Top Recommendations

- ● Slider: Ceiling 115, now 106 (gap +9). The best reachable shape is –2.0 in IVB and 2.0 in glove side. Main lever: spin rate on this pitch. Confidence: High (18 comps).
- ● Four-seam: Ceiling 101, now 93 (gap +8). The best reachable shape is 20.0 in IVB and 5.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 44th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: High (25 comps).
- ◐ Curveball: Ceiling 94, now 84 (gap +10). The best reachable shape is 0.0 in IVB and 3.0 in glove side. Main lever: hand position at release. Confidence: Medium (10 comps).

Top Five Comps

Lucas Giolito (2023)	5 | 55/100/0/23	98
Ryan Fernandez (2024)	5 | 55/100/0/23	97
AJ Smith-Shawver (2023)	5 | 55/100/0/23	97
Mason Montgomery (2025)	5 | 55/100/0/23	95
Anthony Molina (2026)	5 | 55/95/0/23	95

Every Pitch: Today and Potential

Pitch	Usage	Velo	Spin	IVB	HB	Stuff+	Ceiling	Gap	Main Lever	Conf.
Four-seam	28%	93.2	2152	19.2	6.7	93	101	+8	Grip / Seam Orientation	●
Changeup	25%	80.6	1533	8.0	14.5	117	120	+3	Spin Rate on This Pitch	◐
Cutter	15%	89.5	2154	11.0	–0.5	97	94	–2	Grip / Seam Orientation	○
Sinker	14%	93.2	2066	16.7	13.3	90	108	+17	Grip / Seam Orientation	○
Curveball	10%	75.9	2261	–12.2	–10.9	84	94	+10	Hand Position at Release	◐
Slider	9%	85.0	2016	4.5	–1.8	106	115	+9	Spin Rate on This Pitch	●

Velocity in mph, spin in rpm, movement in inches (IVB: induced vertical break; HB: horizontal break from behind the pitcher, arm side positive).

Confidence and Data Notes

Stuff+ is Spin ID's own model, not FanGraphs Stuff+. 100 is the 2021–2024 average pitch. Ceiling: what this pitcher's comps do with each pitch, at this pitcher's own velocity and release; Gap is Ceiling minus today; the lever is the change that adds the most. Fastballs keep their natural spin.

Confidence (● High, ◐ Medium, ○ Low) is how much real MLB data sits behind each estimate. Estimates, not promises.

Validity test T5 passed: Stuff+ in 2025 lined up with 2026 results at r = 0.21, better than velocity alone (0.09) and 2025 results (0.09), over 1,247 pitches.

Tested (T4, 2025 to 2026): bigger gaps came with only slightly bigger next-season Stuff+ gains (partial r 0.07; the range includes zero), so treat a gap as a direction to explore, not a forecast.

2026 season: 3,027 pitches with a pitch type; the Spin ID comes from 840 four-seams. Comps are the nearest Spin IDs (slot, efficiency, tilt offset, spin) among MLB pitcher-seasons 2021–2026.

Spin ID · Schema v1 (frozen 2026-10-11) · stuff-1 · physics-1 · transition-1 · movement-1 · parks-1

Data: MLB Statcast via Baseball Savant. 2026. Printed Oct 13, 2026.